

Lamar spent nearly four years in graduate school. During that time he received two degrees. Today Lamar is a college administrator. But given his annual salary of less than \$60,000, it's still hard for Mary and him to make ends meet. Even with the \$15,000 his mother-in-law provides each year, their income is not high enough to support their upper-middle-class lifestyle. What is so interesting about Mary and Lamar's \$60,000 annual income level is that they are not alone. *About 30 percent of the households in America that live in homes valued at \$300,000 have annual household earned incomes of \$60,000 or less.* Is it because of creative budgeting, or could it be a result of widespread economic outpatient care in America? For the most part, it's because of UAWs on EOC.

According to Mary, it's not too difficult to pay for basic family necessities out of Lamar's income plus her annual cash gift from Mother. What is difficult is purchasing motor vehicles. And Mary and Lamar enjoy "foreign luxury." How do they squeeze such purchases into their budget? Do they buy used cars to reduce the "economic pain"? No, they purchase *new cars every three years*. Why so often? Because that's Mother's cycle. About every three years, Mary's mother gives her daughter stock from her portfolio—so do about 17 percent of America's affluent. Some adult recipients hold onto such gifts, but not Mary and Lamar. They sell the securities immediately, then purchase a new car with the proceeds!

But what will happen to Mary and Lamar after Mother is no longer alive? Obviously, this is a major concern to this couple. Unfortunately, we are not fortune tellers, so we were not able to tell them how much Mother had in trust for her daughter. We wish them good luck. It will not take long for Mary and Lamar to consume even a good-sized inheritance. They are already anticipating this economic windfall. A bigger home, a vacation home, and around-the-world travel are on the horizon.